

## BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

### Are Saunas Good For You?

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Class: \_\_\_\_\_

Score: \_\_\_\_\_ / 20

| No. | Sentence                                                                                          |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | A standard sauna is heated with steam to about _____.                                             |
| 2   | Supporters claim that _____ can improve health and well-being.                                    |
| 3   | One sauna user described the experience as very _____.                                            |
| 4   | The same person said it made them feel _____.                                                     |
| 5   | Another user said saunas may help muscles when a person is _____.                                 |
| 6   | A stressed user felt completely _____ after finishing the sauna.                                  |
| 7   | In Finland, around _____ of the population use saunas.                                            |
| 8   | Sauna-goers were associated with a 40% reduction in _____.                                        |
| 9   | The current findings are based on _____, not fully controlled experiments.                        |
| 10  | The expert says stronger confirmation would require _____, where conditions are fully controlled. |

11 **What question does the introduction raise about saunas?**

- A Whether saunas should replace winter clothing.
- B Whether saunas offer real health benefits as well as warmth.
- C Whether saunas are cheaper in Britain than in Nordic countries.
- D Whether people should build saunas inside their homes.

12 **Why does James ask whether saunas are "all they're cracked up to be"?**

- A To argue that people should stop using them immediately.
- B To show that saunas are already medically proven.
- C To compare British saunas with Finnish bathhouses.
- D To question whether their reputation is fully deserved.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What benefit does the first sauna user emphasise?**
- A It helps them feel calm and comfortable.
  - B It improves their ability to tolerate cold water.
  - C It removes the need for regular exercise.
  - D It helps them sleep for longer afterwards.
- 14 **According to the second user, when might a sauna be particularly useful?**
- A When someone wants to avoid sweating.
  - B When someone has no time to rest.
  - C When someone's muscles feel tight or tense.
  - D When someone wants to train in high temperatures.
- 15 **How does the final sauna user describe the effect after being stressed?**
- A It makes stress feel more serious than before.
  - B It gives them a sense of starting afresh.
  - C It distracts them without changing their mood.
  - D It makes them dependent on daily sauna use.
- 16 **What is Professor Bailey's general reaction to the research evidence?**
- A He thinks it is too weak to discuss publicly.
  - B He believes it only applies to professional athletes.
  - C He is bored by the amount of evidence available.
  - D He finds it impressive, although further testing is needed.
- 17 **Which figure is used to show how common sauna use is in Finland?**
- A About 90% of the population use saunas.
  - B About 40% of people use saunas every winter.
  - C Thousands of people stopped using saunas.
  - D Five million people took part in controlled trials.
- 18 **What limitation of the Finnish evidence is highlighted?**
- A It ignores natural behaviour completely.
  - B It was collected from only a few sauna-goers.
  - C It is observational rather than fully controlled.
  - D It proves that saunas cause every health improvement.

19 **Why does Damian say we should not "turn our noses up" at the current data?**

- A Because controlled trials are impossible in any health research.
- B Because the evidence is large-scale even if it is not perfect.
- C Because Finnish culture should be copied without question.
- D Because observational data is always stronger than RCTs.

20 **What is the balanced conclusion about sauna evidence in the discussion?**

- A It is promising and worth considering, but more controlled research would strengthen it.
- B It is useless because it has not yet been tested in a laboratory.
- C It proves that sauna use is the only reason Finnish people live longer.
- D It shows that personal relaxation benefits are unrelated to health outcomes.